



The market today is flooded with a plethora of tablets and the price of these devices range from ₹5,000 for the budget devices all the way to ₹50,000 for the high-end ASUS Transformer Prime and the third generation iPad. So how do you decide which of these devices is the smartest buy for you? Well we break it down for you by giving details about the specs that matter and the specs that don't – things to consider before making your buying decision.

What matters?

The first question that you need to answer is whether you really need that tablet or not? Even in its third generation of devices, the tablet is still more of a novelty device than utility. If it's productivity you want, you will be able to get a lot more done using a laptop. Of course you can't really compare laptops to a tablet's portability and quick start up time and the ease with which you can connect to the net. However, if you're like every other Indian out there who needs to be able to do work on almost all his gadgets, the tablet's not there just yet.

If you have the cash to blow and want to do nothing more than email, social networking, games, multimedia and just the tiniest bit of productivity – say, viewing office files, or PDFs and such, then a tablet will do nicely indeed.

Display size

The display size of a tablet can be classified into large and small screens. The large screen tablets usually have a display close to 10-inches in size, for example ASUS' Transformer Prime, Samsung's Galaxy Note 800, the Apple's iPad, Micromax's Funbook Pro, etc. The small screen tablets usually have screens that are closer to the 7-inch mark. These include a wider range of products such as the Google Nexus 7, Samsung Galaxy Tab 2, Zync Z999 Plus,

iberry Auxus AX02 and many more. Now the larger screens (10-inch) are ideal for video content. So that includes movies, games, even YouTube, or anything visual. However, this also means that your device is larger, and heavier, and carrying it about can be more painful. Also, no matter what the size of your hands, you will need both of them free to use it properly.

The smaller 7-inch form factor tablets are more suited for portability, of course, you could do that with your smartphone as well, but those usually come with much smaller screens.

Devices such as the Nexus 7, Kindle Fire, Samsung Galaxy Tab 2, and more, double up as really good e-book readers. also, after using these devices, we'd be lying if we said that the regular use of such gadgets is more about social networking and multimedia, and they beat smartphones hollow at that.

Storage space

Once you've decided on a screen size, the next thing to look at is how much you will need to carry around with you. given that a lot of tablets that people are drooling over do not offer memory card slots or any way of extending storage space, you're going to have to choose what's best for you. Starting at as little as 4GB (ridiculously low these days), and going up to 64GB and more, there are a



Just as with monitors or TVs, for tablets as well, display sizes are measured diagonally, and these are the two most popular sizes

wide range of choices made available to you. Now those with money to burn can just buy the maximum storage capacity available, but for the rest of us mere mortals, it comes down to what we can afford. If the tablet you've got your eye on offers expandable memory, you have nothing to worry about, except making

sure the expandable memory type is something popular, easily available and cheap enough to afford.

If you're buying a tablet to just surf, social network, install a few dozen apps, and watch a few SD videos, etc, then a tablet with 8GB of storage might suffice. We cannot in good conscience recommend any of the 4GB budget tabs unless they offer expandable memory, because just about any Digit reader is sure to fill up more than 4GB.

However, if you truly believe there's an app for everything, and are making it your life's goal to prove that fact – in other words, if you're app crazy, and want to try everything you come across – you're going to need more than 8GB of storage. This will keep on increasing depending on other habits, such as if you're buying a tablet to entertain you with movies that you, err, acquired legally, whilst travelling. If you're a gamer to boot, heck you're going to need to find a tablet with large internal memory, and perhaps one that offers external storage as well.

Devices such as the Galaxy Note 800 offer expandable memory up to 64GB via a microSD card, while most other tablets offer up to 32 GB. This is ideal.

Operating system

There are just two dominating OSes in the market today – iOS and Android. Windows 8 powered devices are expected to launch soon and BlackBerry devices are all but dead in the tablet space. iOS edges out Android in terms of apps available, but Android is more liberal, owing to the fact that it's open source.

Of course, this also means that although two people can buy similar specced tablets from different manufacturers, both running the same version of Android, but with very different user interfaces. This is something to be wary of when buying an Android device. You may have seen videos and read reviews of popular Android devices such as the Nexus 7, but when you go out and buy, say, a Samsung, you will find the interface is completely different. That's because Samsung devices are skinned with TouchWiz, and other tablets have different custom UIs. There are also a plethora of skins available to users via the Google Play store, so you can